

THE EASY GUIDE TO

ONLINE MESSAGING

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A Word About Online Game...

It goes without saying, but online dating has been an absolute game-changer. A revolution in dating the likes the world has never seen.

And it's not going away anytime soon.

For nearly the past two decades, I've been actively figuring out ways to game the system in a way that most guys don't even realize is possible.

Once you figure it out, online dating can be an absolute bonanza of matches and dates.

That said, for most guys, online dating seems like a complete head-scratcher.

And texting happens to be one of the biggest mysteries. A mystery that really shouldn't be a mystery...

...especially if you have a system. (I'm a fan of systems).

Welcome to the simple guide to messaging.

Basically everything I do when I match with a girl, from open to close.

Essentially 20 years of texting boiled down into the pages you're about to read.

It's my model for always responding in ways that spark attraction and flirty banter
...

...as well as guide the conversation towards a close. A hookup. A date. A relationship.

Good luck...but hey, who needs luck when you have skill.

-Todd V

The First Message

Fact: You never get a second chance to make a first impression.

The first message you send is INSTRUMENTAL in having successful online interactions.

Because unlike the real world, with online dating there are NO LIMITS to the number of guys who can bombard the hottest girls with messages.

All the more reason to learn how to rise above the rest.

Your message should be interesting, casual, and should provoke a response.

That can be a difficult mix to conjure up, so most guys swing and miss BADLY with messages like:

- “Hey.”
- “Nice body.”
- “DTF?”
- “You know, I read your profile and I really hope you like me because I think we have a lot in common. Let’s go on a date tonight.”

Boring texts that require the girl to carry the load of the conversation will almost never work.

Extremely obvious and sexual texts are mostly a really bad idea.

If they do, chances are it worked on a girl who already liked you a lot BEFORE you sent the message, so it still didn’t accomplish much. (Or lead you to a swift unmatched from a quality girl who will roll her eyes at that approach).

Newsflash...

Needy messages will end up left on read, just like the dozens of other needy messages attractive girls receive.

NEVER try to make plans with the first message of an online conversation.

FIRST MESSAGES THAT WORK

Here are a few examples of online openers that are likely to get a response:

“You’re adorable, fingers crossed that you’re not crazy.”

“If you can still do a backflip, I’ll buy you a drink.” (referencing something in her profile)

“You seem so sweet I think you might cause cavities ;)” (Works on girls that are particularly wholesome)

This is just a sample.

There’s a lot more where that came from and here’s a major point...

BIG KEY: Each first message is calibrated to the girl. For example, I wouldn’t use that last text on a more “party” type of girl.

These are messages that I’ve personally had success with, although no longer use, feel free to use them, but the better way is to come up with your own.

Teasing, evaluating, and complimenting without going over the top can go a long way.

Tailoring a message to a girl in a way that’s both casual and non-needy can go a long way. (This is often my preferred way).

Ideally you’d have a proven system for quick first messages that are both tailored to the girl, and easy to come up with.

Essentially that’s what I do.

What Comes Next?

So, you’ve sent the first text (and she’s hopefully answered), now what?

Well, now we need to do a very quick exploration of female psychology.

As men, our attraction to women is a bit like a light switch. On or off. Attracted or not.

For women, attraction is not so binary . . . it’s more like a dimmer switch, with her attraction increasing or decreasing over time based on the actions you take.

Evolutionary psychology provides many reasons as to why this is the case, and why women care about more than a man's appearance. For the purposes of this guide, however, let's focus on the practical applications of these facts.

You need to know where you stand at any given point in an interaction.

If a girl is really into you, you should be making plans and not wasting time.

If her attraction is much lower, trying to make plans might end the conversation right then and there.

In messaging, the only information that tells you her emotional state is what you can DECIPHER from her texts.

Fortunately, the code is very simple because out of the infinite number of texts you may receive, they all stem from just a FEW FORMATS.

Four to be exact.

The Four Types of Texts You Can Receive

Guys struggle to attract women online for the same reasons they struggle to do so in person.

They don't know what to say or when to say it. And I don't blame them.

There are billions of ways interactions can go.

So how can a guy excel under such unpredictable circumstances?

Well, you create a model.

Or, since you're reading this, just follow mine.

While my online dating experience started on desktop computers nearly two decades ago, the principles I learned to win the online dating game back then still apply now.

You see, there are ONLY FOUR TYPES of texts you will EVER receive.

1. Silence
2. Shit test
3. Logical (or logical questions)
4. Clearly positive

And if you're doing things right, you'll also receive them roughly in that order.

Each type serves as a signpost for how she feels about you.

Silence means she's not bought in. You have to build value and trust.

Positive means she's invested—you should make plans to hang out.

If you're in the middle, facing shit tests and logical texts, you're in a good place. You'll learn how to use these texts as a springboard toward plans.

Occasionally, you'll get a text that's a combination of two types, but we'll get to that later.

For now, pat yourself on the back for recognizing these four text-types.

You ALREADY possess greater online dating skills than 75% of guys out there.

What follows is what will FULLY separate you from the pack.

1. Dealing With Silence

iMessage
Today 16:56



Read 16:56

.

People aren't books. Nobody likes being left on read.

But at least silence tells you where you're at: nowhere.

To go from nowhere to somewhere, you should do what I call "pinging value into the void."

Send her something funny, cool, or interesting. Social media updates, pictures, videos, and memes all work here. Ideally, it relates to you BOTH—or at least to her.

If it gets a response, great.

If it doesn't, you shared something cool with her.

It's a win-win.

DON'T DO THIS - When you've been left on read, here's what you DON'T do in your next text: ask questions or try to make plans. You're welcome.

Think about it.

She wasn't invested enough to answer your last text. Suddenly she's going to answer your boring questions and meet up with you?

Not likely.

Instead, break the silence by pinging value into the void.

The best VERSIONS of pinging value into the void are:

1. Related to the previous conversation in some way
2. Instigating messages. Meaning there is something in them that makes a girl want to respond. This can be a tease, a challenge, something intriguing, etc.



As you can see in this example, all that was needed to resuscitate this interaction was:

1. The willingness to send another message and...
2. A message that was related, in good humor, and suggestive of a response.

One last note about turning around silence.

Don't expect it to work every single time. Girls have different reasons for going silent and some have absolutely nothing to do with you.

But if you're gonna reignite the conversation with something, the method above is a great way to do it.

2. Passing Shit Tests



Despite its name, shit tests are a GOOD thing.

A shit test is an obstacle women throw at you to determine if you're valuable (confident, witty, smart, funny, etc.) enough to be worth their time.

If she's shit testing you, it means you've intrigued her enough to be worth that evaluation in the first place.

So always remember, if she shit tests you, **YOU'RE ON HER RADAR.**

And if you have her attention, you should be able to make plans most of the time. . . assuming you handle the situation well.

But how?

Just like in real life, when you encounter a shit test, JUST PASS IT!

And don't follow up on your response to the shit test either.

Don't ask a question in addition to your answer and DO NOT try to make plans off of a shit test! Just pass it.

For more on HOW to pass a shit test, watch this [video](#).

Passing should build enough value that she'll want to continue the conversation of her own volition.

The exception to this rule is if you passed the shit test in a purely defensive way—by acknowledging it but NOT challenging her.

An example of this would be responding to a shit test by saying, "Yeah, I have no response to that. Can we just be normal now?" Which is an okay (but not great) response to a shit test in person, but not a very good one in text messaging.

Responding this way may elicit MORE shit tests, to which you SHOULD push back a bit.

Always remember that shit tests are opportunities to up your value and hook her. Study this guide and you'll ace them.



In this example, the girl's (probably fake) offer of her roommate's number is a shit test.

Your answer will indicate your neediness, sense of humor, and ability to respond to an unexpected obstacle. Hence the TEST in shit test.

My answer is positive, non-needy, and funny. Also note that I keep the conversation RELEVANT to the girl I'm messaging rather being sidetracked by the topic of the roommate.

Finally, I challenge the girl back in the interaction, first by sarcastically complimenting her sense of humor, then later by questioning her judgment in roommate selection and suggesting I won't be STAYING OVER.

3. Logical and Platonic

Today 12:52 PM

Hey, how was your weekend?

Good, you?

Delivered

Same.

Look familiar?

While they are boring, logical texts are a GOOD THING.

She's taking the time and effort to text you. That means she likes you.

And yet, most guys get STUCK in this online dating purgatory.

Which is why I developed a simple format to help you escape it.

DEALING WITH LOGICAL TEXTS

- 1. Comment on the logical part**
- 2. Move the conversation forward**

If you get a logical text that's either negative or neutral in terms of her emotional investment, respond with a text that is logical but flirty.

On the other hand, if she sends you a logical-positive text, answer in a logical way that sways toward MAKING PLANS.

Logical-flirty and logical-logistical are examples of those combo texts I referred to earlier.

LOGICAL-NEGATIVE OR LOGICAL-NEUTRAL TEXT FROM HER → LOGICAL-FLIRTY TEXT FROM YOU

LOGICAL-POSITIVE TEXT FROM HER → LOGICAL-LOGISTICAL TEXT FROM YOU



In this case, we start with a conversation that is not only logical, but also on an unhelpful topic (her NOT looking to hook up).

The good news is that she was responsive.

So, we follow the format (albeit with longer texts than normal in this case):

1. Respond to the logical part, then
2. Move the interaction forward in a manner that isn't too committing too soon.

As we can see, the interaction goes well from here.

4. Positive Messages

When your Tinder date has a good sense of humor, is attractive and has a good job but doesn't like memes



Almost every guy tries to make plans.

Few do it correctly and even fewer at the right time.

When you're getting positive responses, it's time to START making plans.

Don't randomly hit her with, "Hey, drinks at X place at Y time on Z day?"

Too sudden, too specific, too needy.

First, you need to screen if she's even down for plans in the first place.

Second, you've got to generally understand her schedule if you're going to ask her to block out time for you.

The close should take a few texts, rather than an all-in-one make-or-break text. This ups your chances of success and also allows you to avoid overcommitting if things aren't looking good midway through.

First, I'll send a qualifier like, "Are you an adventurous person?"

She's likely to say yes because saying no makes her seem boring and lame. If things had been positive to this point such that it made sense for me to try to make plans in the first place, she'll want to seem fun and exciting, so she'll say yes.

Then I'll make a VAGUE suggestion like, "What's your view on flirting with a handsome and funny man over drinks?"

If that gets a positive response, simply find out her schedule and make plans.

If you're feeling confident she'd answer a phone call (which can only help your cause), you can also pick up the phone and call her.

It's best to do this RIGHT AFTER she sent you a text because she'll know that you know that she's on her phone.

Guys NEVER do this anymore, which is exactly why you SHOULD.

Hearing your voice and getting a sense of your personality over the phone will drastically increase the chances of her actually showing up to the plans you're making.

Obviously this is for once you get her off the app and communicating by text, but it's a very valuable addition to your communication arsenal!

This ability to call is one reason why I personally prefer the strategy of app -> phone -> date, rather than app -> date. Though, with good messaging either path is viable.



In this case, things are going well, so it's clearly TIME TO CLOSE. Remember to close in STAGES rather than all at once!

How to Win the Game

Online dating is a game, pure and simple.

Once you've optimized your profile to consistently get matches, a subject for another time, you're officially in the game.

Every message you ever get from a girl falls into one of four types of categories. At its most complicated, it'll mostly fall into just two of four.

With this model in mind, online messaging becomes less of a head-scratcher, and more of a process.

And just like that, you know exactly what to say and when to say it.

You're welcome.

Talk soon,

-Todd V